

Employability Readiness Program

for Commerce Graduates

A non-technical skills framework for EWS / first-generation learners from Tier-3 school and college backgrounds

1. Why This Program Is Needed

Commerce graduates from Aasha Infinite Foundation's learner base carry a distinct combination of constraints that generic "interview prep" or "soft skills" content does not address:

- Local-language schooling through the secondary level, with limited comprehension (not just speaking hesitancy) in English
- Tier-3 school and college education, often with limited exposure to structured career guidance
- Introversion that is largely situational — hesitation in front of authority or unfamiliar people, not a lack of ideas or opinions
- Little first-hand exposure to today's workplace vocabulary, tools, and Gen Z professional culture
- Rural, low-literacy parents and tight household finances, which shape both confidence and the practical questions they get asked in interviews

This program is designed to close the employability gap for this specific profile — not to re-teach commerce subject knowledge, but to build the communication, confidence, and interview-readiness skills that sit between a completed degree and a first job offer.

2. Program Objectives

1. Build working (not just textbook) English comprehension and speaking confidence for interview and workplace settings
2. Orient learners to today's professional and Gen Z workplace ecosystem — vocabulary, tools, and unwritten norms
3. Prepare learners to handle tough, commerce-role-specific interview questions with honest, confident answers
4. Build group discussion and basic aptitude readiness for campus drives and walk-in interviews
5. Produce a fresher-appropriate resume and a functional digital presence (LinkedIn/Naukri)
6. Address family and economic-context questions directly, without shame or over-scripted corporate language

3. Program Modules

Module 1 — Foundational English & Communication

Starts one level below typical "spoken English" content, since comprehension — not just fluency — is often the real gap.

- **Bilingual scaffolding:** short passages presented in local language alongside English, moving learners from recognition to production
- **Daily JAM practice:** 1-minute impromptu speaking on simple, familiar topics (never commerce jargon at this stage)
- **WhatsApp voice-note pods:** groups of 3–4 learners record and exchange 60–90 second answers, with peer feedback before any trainer involvement
- **Common error sheets:** article usage, tense, and preposition drills specific to errors typical of the local-language-to-English transition

Module 2 — Gen Z Workplace Ecosystem Orientation

A standalone module, not an aside — the goal is that a learner who clears the interview does not then feel lost on day one.

- Everyday workplace vocabulary: reporting manager, onboarding, appraisal, KRA, escalation, TAT, EOD
- Professional WhatsApp/email norms vs. personal chat habits
- What LinkedIn is, how recruiters use it, and how to build a basic profile
- Office etiquette: punctuality, dress code, addressing seniors, meeting behaviour
- Orientation to common entry-level commerce workplaces: CA/tax firms, bank branches, NBFCs, retail chains, BPO/KPO back-offices, e-commerce operations

Module 3 — Commerce-Specific Interview Preparation

Question banks and answer frameworks built around the roles this learner group typically interviews for: accounts assistant, junior accountant, GST/tax executive, banking sales and operations, retail cashier/associate, back-office and data-entry roles, BPO/KPO finance-process roles.

- **Background questions:** "Tell me about yourself", "Why commerce", "Why this gap / why distance learning" — using a simple Present–Past–Future template rather than memorised scripts
- **Role-readiness questions:** "Do you know Tally / basic GST filing / MS Excel", "Have you handled cash or customer queries before" — honest-answer coaching for learners who may not have formal exposure yet
- **Pressure and curveball questions:** a bank of 40–50 commonly asked questions with an improvisation framework, not answers to memorise word-for-word
- **Salary and shift questions:** simple scripts for "What salary do you expect", "Are you okay with rotational shifts", "Can you relocate"
- **Dignity-first family-context answers:** confident, non-apologetic responses to "Why should we invest in training you" or "Why do you want to relocate for this salary"

Module 4 — Group Discussion & Aptitude Readiness

- GD topic bank with a simple self/peer scoring rubric — initiation, listening, relevance, conclusion
- Peer-only GD practice pods before any trainer-observed round, to reduce performance anxiety
- Basic quantitative and logical reasoning refreshers — the same question types repeat across TCS NQT-style tests, bank clerical exams, and campus aptitude rounds regardless of stream

Module 5 — Resume & Digital Presence

- One-page fresher resume template (not an experienced-professional format)
- LinkedIn and Naukri profile checklist — headline, summary, keyword use for recruiter search
- Email etiquette templates: application email, follow-up, thank-you note after interview

Module 6 — Confidence, Dignity & Honest Self-Presentation

Many first-generation learners under-perform in interviews not from lack of ability but from fear of being judged for their background.

- Reframing "I don't know the answer" as an acceptable, honest response rather than something to hide
- Practice in stating rural/EWS background factually and without apology, when it comes up
- Short breathing and pause techniques so silence reads as thinking-time, not failure

4. Sample Tough-Question Bank (Commerce Roles)

A starting set for Module 3 resource development. Each should ship with an answer framework, not a fixed script.

Category	Sample Question	What the Framework Should Teach
Background	Why should we hire a fresher with no experience?	Bridge transferable strengths (accuracy, willingness to learn, discipline) to the role's actual needs
Technical basics	Do you know how to use Tally / Excel / file GST returns?	Honest yes/no + evidence of self-learning intent, never bluffing
Commitment	Are you okay with rotational shifts / relocation?	Direct, confident yes/no with one practical caveat if genuinely needed
Salary	What salary are you expecting?	Simple range-anchoring script tied to role and market, not guesswork
Background/family	Why is there a gap after graduation?	Factual, non-defensive explanation (distance learning, family responsibility, upskilling)
Pressure	Sell me this pen / convince me in 30 seconds	Structure-over-content: feature, benefit, close — practised on unfamiliar objects
Motivation	Where do you see yourself in 3 years?	Realistic, role-anchored answer avoiding over-ambitious clichés

5. Delivery Model

Reuses the audio-first, low-bandwidth delivery pattern validated in the Foundation's spoken English program, extended across every module — not just language.

- Weekly themed resource drop: one short PDF/audio pack per module topic
- WhatsApp peer-practice pods of 3–4 learners for low-stakes rehearsal before any trainer interaction
- One live or recorded mock-interview per module, with peer or trainer feedback
- Minimal-text, audio-first formatting throughout — some learners may be first-time users of structured digital learning, not just low-bandwidth users

6. Light Assessment Structure

Area	How It's Checked	Frequency
Spoken English	Self/peer-rated JAM recordings	Weekly
Interview readiness	Recorded mock interview against tough-question bank	End of Module 3
GD skills	Peer rubric scoring in practice pods	Bi-weekly
Resume/LinkedIn	Trainer checklist review	End of Module 5
Overall confidence	Short self-assessment survey	Start and end of program

7. Suggested Rollout Timeline

Week	Focus
1–2	Module 1: Foundational English & Communication

Week	Focus
3	Module 2: Gen Z Workplace Ecosystem Orientation
4–5	Module 3: Commerce-Specific Interview Preparation
6	Module 4: Group Discussion & Aptitude Readiness
7	Module 5: Resume & Digital Presence
8	Module 6: Confidence & Dignity + Final Mock Interviews

Prepared for Aasha Infinite Foundation — internal program framework, non-technical employability track for commerce graduates.